

Describe an activity you do to keep healthy

You should say:

- What you do
- When and where you usually do it
- How you do it
- And explain why it can keep you healthy

This is a good topic for me to talk about because I'm quite a sporty person.

I wouldn't say I'm a fitness fanatic or a fitness freak, but I do like keeping fit. The thing that I do to keep fit and healthy is swimming.

This is quite an easy activity to do because you don't need loads of equipment. In total, all you need is a swimming costume or trunks, goggles and a towel. You don't actually even need the goggles, but personally, I wear them because I find the chlorine in the water stings my eyes if I don't. I tend to go swimming at my local pool, on average three times a week. The good thing about swimming is that it is a solitary activity so I don't need to make plans with my friends to do it. I can just go along, get changed and then dive in.

Cue Card - Activity

In addition to it being a **comparatively cheap** sport to do, it is actually a great sport **in terms of** fitness. It is also a **cardiovascular exercise** which means that it is the kind of **workout** that gets your **blood pumping**, raises your heart rate, **boosts your lung capacity** and **burns calories**. Swimming achieves all four of these with the added benefit of **weightlessness** that **reduces impact on your joints**.

As well as the health benefits for your body, I feel that it has other benefits for your **mental health**. **For example**, when **you are swimming**, you can just **shut out the world** and **escape from the rat race**. **Nowadays**, the **pace of life** is so fast that we don't often **take time out**. Swimming **provides the opportunity** to do that.

Describe a (long) car journey you have been on

You should say:

- Where you went
- What you did when you got there
- Why you went there
- And explain why you went on that journey by car

Most of my outings are done by car so I could have chosen from a long list of trips; however, there is one particular journey that I would like to talk about and it was memorable because it was long and arduous, but my family and I had a remarkable experience when we reached our destination. We went by car, as I'm not a fan of public transport. I can't stand being controlled by timetables and love the freedom of coming and going when I please.

The journey in question was from Orlando to Clearwater Bay, when I was holidaying in America last year. We were staying in Orlando, but had planned to go to Clearwater, as it is famous for the wild dolphins that swim in the bay area. My cousin had told me that the journey would take roughly two hours by car so we set off at 8am, planning to arrive at around 10am. Then we would be able to have some brunch before going on the boat to spot dolphins. Well, that was the plan, but things never go to plan, do they?

Cue Card - Activity

About an hour into the journey, we suddenly hit **traffic congestion**.

Annoyingly, the traffic had come to a standstill. I tried to be **optimistic** and said that it's probably only **roadworks** and we would be on our way soon. Five hours later, we finally arrived at our destination, three hours later than planned!

Grumpy, fed up and starving, we had a quick bite to eat and then bought tickets for the boat trip. **We were all in a bad mood** and **nobody was talking**. About five minutes into the boat trip, there was suddenly **a gasp** and a shout of 'look'. We looked over the side of the boat and saw **the most incredible sight** – **a pod of dolphins** jumping in and out of the water. **Instantly**, the grumpiness and tiredness that **we were all feeling** because of that **horrendously** long car journey disappeared and we were **delighted** that we had seen **these amazing creatures** in their **natural habitat**.

Describe a plan you made and later changed

You should say:

- What the plan was
- When you changed your mind
- Why you changed your mind
- And explain how you felt about it

This is **actually** something that happened to me very recently. **I was planning to take** a trip to Disneyworld in Florida with my family; **we've been** there a couple of times before and **my kids were pestering me to go** again. We only had a week's holiday and **I really fancied going** there **to have a break from the routine**. Everyday life can become **monotonous** and **wearisome** and I felt that we all needed some sunshine and **a chance to let off steam**.

I spent a couple of weeks researching hotels and flights, trying to find the best price because I'm very careful with money and don't like to **overspend**. To help me with this process, I created an excel spreadsheet with all the **costings** because **I was trying to work to a budget** that **I had set myself**. When I finally reached the stage that I was happy with **the choices I had made**, **particularly** because **it was coming in under budget**, I got out my credit card to make the booking.

Cue Card - Activity

The first thing to do was book the flights and I **input** all my details and my family's and then got to the page where you put in the credit card details. I **filled in** the long credit card number, **the security code and the expiry date** and then **suddenly** I **hesitated**. I can't even explain why, but **the cursor was just hovering over** the 'pay now' button and I couldn't click it.

So many **thoughts were going through** my head and **I was having doubts about spending** such **an astronomical amount of money, comparatively speaking**, for a week in the sun. **Thoughts popped into my head** of how I could better spend that money and so I never pressed the button. Do I **regret** it? Yes and no. Yes, **because** next week **I won't be lying** in the sun or meeting Mickey Mouse, **but, on the other hand, I won't be feeling guilty for splashing out on an overpriced holiday. We're going to have a staycation instead.**

Describe a time when you helped someone

You should say:

- What the situation was
- Who you helped
- How you helped
- And explain how you felt after giving the help

I like to think I'm always ready **to lend a hand to** anyone, but **I was struggling** to think of a situation to talk about, but then I remembered a time when **I was studying** in high school and the teacher asked us to do a project, in which we had to make a video about the **architecture** in our city.

The problem was that we only had **a limited time** so **I delegated the task of** filming videos on their smartphones of **noteworthy** or **stunningly beautiful** buildings to my groupmates and then sending them to me. **As soon as** I got the video clips, I got to work putting together the video. I used movie maker and included some **narration** on the video as well as **subtitles**.

Cue Card - Activity

When we **submitted** it, my teacher was **impressed** and commented that it looked like **it had been made** by a university student. She then asked if **I could do her a favour** and show her how to edit videos using movie maker. **Naturally**, I was happy to be able to share my skills, **since** we often learn from our teachers but this time, I was the teacher.

Initially, it felt a bit **weird** that **our roles had reversed** and I was the teacher and she was the student; **however**, I quickly forgot all about it and started to enjoy it. It made me realise that I am more **patient** and **easy-going** than I thought I was and maybe I could become a teacher myself one day. Showing someone how to do something is **unbelievably rewarding** and it gave me **a real sense of satisfaction**.

Describe a trip that you took using public transport

You should say:

- Where you went
- What public transport you used
- Who you were with
- And explain how you felt about the trip

To be perfectly honest, I **rarely** use public transport, as I **live in the middle of nowhere**, **therefore**, it is more **practical** for me to use my car, as there are no public transport options in my village. **However**, only a couple of weeks ago, I **did use** public transport for a trip to **our capital city** because I had tickets for a BTS concert.

Because it was on a Tuesday evening and I didn't want my daughter to **miss** too much school, the quickest way to get there was by train and underground. Just after lunch, I **picked her up** from school and **raced to** the train station and got **the high-speed train** to London. Just over two hours later, we arrived and then **rushed to** the underground to get to our hotel. The hotel **was located** a 20-minute walk away from the underground and the O2 where the concert **was being held**, but **due to time constraints** we took a taxi, quickly **freshened up** and then walked back to **the arena**.

Cue Card - Activity

How did I feel about the trip? Well, on the one hand, it was more relaxing than going by car because I didn't have the stress of driving in **rush-hour traffic** or **getting stuck in a traffic jam**, **but, on the other hand,** trains in my country **are renowned for** being late and because my **schedule** was **tight**, I was a bit stressed about the train being **delayed**.

Luckily, everything worked out perfectly and there were no **delays**. I was a bit **anxious** when **I was going** across London on the underground because **it was teeming with people** and I had my daughter with me and I didn't want to get **separated** from her. The trip was good because of **the ease and convenience**, but I would hate to live in London and be **a commuter** on the London underground every day.

Describe a time when you played an indoor game

You should say:

- What it was
- Who you played it with
- Where you played it
- And explain how you felt about it

It was quite tricky to think of a game to talk about because I don't tend to play many indoor games nowadays, but then I suddenly remembered a game I was pushed into playing at a family get-together a few years back. My aunt and uncle were celebrating their golden wedding anniversary (50) and invited their close friends and relatives to a party at their home. They live in a relatively large house and it is great for entertaining.

I can't remember precisely when it was because I have a terrible memory for dates, but it was sometime in summer, but unfortunately the weather was pretty awful. It was pouring down and so we couldn't go outside and use the garden so we were stuck inside. The kids were a bit stir crazy* so my uncle suggested that they play board games. Initially, they were not keen because youngsters nowadays are obsessed with gadgets and online gaming and playing old-fashioned board games does not appeal to them. However, that all changed when we started playing Twister.

*stir crazy = restless because of confinement

Cue Card - Activity

I don't know if **you are familiar with** the game, but **basically** it's a game with **a plastic sheet covered in round brightly coloured circles** and there is **a spinner thingy** which you **spin around** and if it **lands on** a red circle then you must put a hand or a foot on that circle. **The object of the game** is to not fall over and only your hands and feet can touch the circles. If you fall or take your hand or foot off a circle, then you are **out**.

At first, some of the players were a bit **shy** and **embarrassed** but as the game **progressed**, we couldn't stop laughing. It is a **hilarious** game to play and we had great fun. Now, every time I see some of my younger cousins, they **beg** me to play the game. It's a fantastic game because **it can be played** by all ages and **even though** it is a bit **childish***, it's great to bring out **your inner child**** from time to time.

***childish** = silly and immature

****your inner child** = the part of your personality that still acts and feels like a child

PART 3

What indoor games do children like to play nowadays?

Well, speaking from experience, the current generation of kids is obsessed with online gaming.

This could be on a PC, Xbox, PS4 etc or a hand-held device such as a mobile phone or... what are they called... it's slipped my mind...

Oh, it's a Nintendo thingy... switch maybe?

These games get bad press*; however, studies have proven that they're good for developing cognitive skills so I don't see this change from board games to online games a negative thing.

***To get bad press** = If someone or something gets bad press, they are criticised, especially in the newspapers, on television, or on radio. If they get good press, they are praised.

Describe a water sport you would like to try in the future

You should say:

- What it is
- Where you would like to try it
- How difficult it is
- And explain why you would like to try it

To be perfectly honest, I am not someone who is totally comfortable in water. I can swim and I would say I'm a proficient swimmer, but it's not something I particularly enjoy. Having said that though, there is something that I've always been fascinated by and that is SCUBA* diving. This is where you dive underwater with breathing apparatus so you are able to stay underwater for a longer time because you have an oxygen supply. As well as the SCUBA equipment, you need a wet suit to keep you warm.

One the major reasons why I am attracted to doing this is that some of the places where you can do this are stunningly beautiful. For example, in Australia, if you are visiting the Gold Coast, you can SCUBA dive at the Great Barrier Reef. I have seen photos and videos of it and the colours of the flora*, fauna* and the marine animals that live there are so vivid and I hope to see it with my own eyes at least once in my lifetime.

SCUBA* = Self Contained Underwater Breathing Apparatus

Flora* is plant life; fauna* refers to animals.

Cue Card - Activity

At certain times of the year, you can see dolphins and whales and one of the things on my bucket list is to swim with dolphins. If I was swimming underwater with dolphins, I imagine it would be one of the greatest and most memorable experiences of my life.

Sadly, this is not something that is going to be easy to do, as it costs a fortune/an arm and a leg to go to Australia so I need to save up.

Ideally, I would like to do it in the near future, but I might need a lottery win in order to pay for it. I imagine that as soon as I am underwater my aquaphobia will disappear. Actually, I'm not aquaphobic, I just don't like getting wet, but I would definitely be prepared to get wet if I was SCUBA diving in the Great Barrier Reef.

PART 3

Why do you think people like to go to places near water?

I guess there are several explanations/reasons for this...

Firstly, there is something very soothing about water. Being near it has a calming effect on you.

And secondly, it is generally picturesque when there is a lake, stream, the sea, whatever and it makes you feel more relaxed because you feel like you are on holiday. Being near water can help to recharge your batteries.



Describe an activity you do when you are alone in your free time

You should say:

- What the activity is
- How often you do it
- How you do it/where you do it
- And explain why you like doing this activity

To be perfectly honest, I don't have a great deal of free time because I am snowed under with work/my studies at the moment; however, there is one thing I have been doing a lot recently and that is learning English. Obviously, because I am taking the IELTS exam, I need to improve my English for this so I have been studying every spare moment I have. Fortunately, it's not something I have to be in a specific location for... thanks to the internet, there is a plethora of resources available so I can do it any time, any place.

Depending where I am, I study in different ways. If I am at home, I will either study in my office or bedroom and I'll focus on grammar or reading activities. If I'm out and about, then it's tricky to focus on intense things like grammar so I tend to listen to podcasts or watch YouTube videos to help me with my listening skills. I tend to listen to music in English as well, so I'm kind of studying when I'm just listening to music and chilling out.

Cue Card - Activity

Like I said, how I do it depends on where I am so at home I'll use my computer **whereas** when **I'm travelling or waiting** for something like a doctor's appointment, I'll use my phone. I try to do it as much as possible, but **it's hard to estimate how much time I spend doing it each day – it's little and often.**

As previously mentioned, **I am studying** English for IELTS, but not just that, **I am hoping to** relocate to Canada so being **proficient** in English is vital for when I move there. **In addition to that**, I actually enjoy learning the language and some of my favourite **bands** are English and American so when **I'm listening to** them, it doesn't feel like studying. I also enjoy watching English dramas and **although** I watch them with subtitles, I feel that **my vocabulary is improving.**

PART 3

Do young people in your country work longer hours now than in the past?

Oh my goodness, 100% yes, but my parents would probably argue otherwise.

In the past, many used to have nine-to-five jobs, but now most people start at 7 and are not finished until 7 and then work at home in the evenings.

I feel that mobile phones, email and the Internet are largely to blame for this. We are always available and are expected to deal with things immediately.

PART 3

What are the advantages and disadvantages of flexible work time?

Firstly, one of the major benefits of flexible working is the flexibility to fit in appointments or school visits around your work.

For working mums and dads, who have to do the school run, they can drop off and pick up their kids from school.

However, if you work in the service industry or in the healthcare sector then flexible working often isn't possible because you need to work fixed hours or night shifts.

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YEATS

Describe a time you taught something to a younger person

You should say:

- When it was
- What it was and who you taught it to
- Why you taught it
- And explain how you felt about it

I was struggling to think of a situation to talk about because I'm not a teacher so teaching is not something I do on a regular basis. Part of the reason for this is I am not the most patient person in the world and I think that to be a good teacher you need loads of patience. Anyway, then I remembered that not so long ago I taught my brother/son/sister/daughter how to make chocolate brownies. He/she had invited some friends round and wanted to make something for them to eat, but he/she had never cooked or baked before so he/she asked for my help.

Although brownies are somewhat straightforward, we made triple chocolate brownies so they were slightly more complex than a plain chocolate brownie. And I'd like to add that there is an art to cooking brownies – if you undercook them, they are too runny and if you overcook them, they are too dry.

Cue Card - Activity

We were **delighted** with **his/her first attempt** because they were **spot on** – not too **runny nor** too **dry**. All of the guests **complimented him/her** and said they were the best brownies **they had ever tasted**.

When **we were making them**, I realised that I am not as **impatient** as I thought I was. **Don't get me wrong**, I'm not saying that I could be a teacher full-time, but for **a one-off task** such as this, I really enjoyed it. This is probably because my brother/son/sister/daughter is a good student. **He/She listened carefully to the instructions** and **followed them to the letter***.

One of the hardest things when teaching is when people don't listen – that's when **mistakes** happen. **Hopefully, in the near future**, I will teach him/her to make a few other things, but **I'm snowed under with work** at the moment so I'm not entirely sure when that will be.

* If **you follow instructions or rules to the letter**, you do exactly what you have been told to do, giving great attention to every detail

PART 3

What skills do adults need to have?

Oh my goodness, there are too many to mention...

There are **practical skills** such as cooking because if you can't cook then you will have **a diet of processed food or takeaways and this could lead to obesity.**

Then there are **work-related skills**, for example, time-management skills, interpersonal skills, IT skills...

And not forgetting social skills such as being self-confident, communication skills, the list is endless, I'm afraid.



Describe a time you taught something to an old person

You should say:

- When it was
- Who you taught
- What you taught
- And explain how you felt about it

There are a number of occasions I could talk about, but the one I've chosen to talk about is the time I taught my neighbour how to use Microsoft Word. I can smile about it now, but believe me it was not a pleasurable experience in any way shape or form.

So, it was a few years back when I was living in my old house/apartment and we used to have a neighbour called Judy. She was a lovely sweet lady and I got on really well with her so when she asked me if I would show her how to type a letter on Word I willingly/happily agreed, and we arranged a time for the following week. In my job, I regularly train other members of staff so I didn't give it a second thought and just expected to have a pleasant time with her showing her how to use this piece of software. How wrong I was!

Cue Card - Activity

When I arrived at her house, I opened up a blank document and started explaining a few key things such as how to save the document and she waved her hand angrily and said 'I don't need to know that, just show me how to do the letter'. I am quite a calm and patient person, but oh my goodness she really tested my patience. Rather than allowing me to explain things in a logical order she wanted to do it her way.

On reflection, I think she was a bit embarrassed that she needed a younger person to show her because she had worked in a senior management position before she retired and was highly respected in her field, but this was back in the days before the widespread use of computers. I guess she felt frustrated* by her lack of knowledge and skills. After a tricky and testing hour, she managed to do the letter and we had a coffee and she did apologise for her offhand behaviour. I wouldn't say you can't teach an old dog new tricks**, but you need loads of patience to do it!

*frustrated = feeling annoyance resulting from an inability to change or achieve something e.g. Young people get frustrated with the system.

(the system = the government or a social organization that controls people's lives)

**you can't teach an old dog new tricks = it is very difficult to teach someone new skills or to change someone's habits or character

PART 3

What are the advantages and disadvantages of old people using smart phones?

To be perfectly honest, I'm struggling to think of any drawbacks other than cost so if they can afford one, there are multiple/numerous benefits.

Firstly, they can get help in the event of an emergency so if they are out and about or in bed and cannot get to the landline, they can use their mobile.

Secondly, playing games on gadgets can be good for mental health and help to keep the mind/brain sharp and focused.

Another positive factor is that they can be used to remind them to take medication by setting an alarm on the phone.

If someone's brain or mind is **sharp** or even **raser-sharp** it means that the person thinks clearly and quickly

Describe a time you solved a problem through the internet

You should say:

- When and what it was
- How you solved this problem
- How long it took to solve the problem
- And explain how you felt about it

To be perfectly honest, I think I use the internet on a daily basis to solve one problem or another. I cannot imagine life without it because as soon as I am struggling with anything, I turn to the internet for help.

I recently bought a new computer and when I set it up, everything was working fine until I tried to print a document and a box appeared on the screen which said 'Unable to find printer'. I've had the printer for a good few years and I couldn't find the instructions that came with the printer when I bought it. I consider myself to be computer literate, but everything I tried didn't work and I was becoming increasingly exasperated/infuriated/annoyed. After half an hour of connecting and reconnecting the printer to the PC, it was still not working so I went on YouTube.

Cue Card - Activity

Within a couple of minutes, I found a video of someone explaining how to connect my **make and model** of printer to a computer. The video was great – **to the point, no waffle** and really easy to follow.

Although the internet and, **in particular**, YouTube is great, sometimes you need to watch loads of **nonsense** before they get to the bit that is useful. **I have even watched** many videos and got to the end and I still didn't know how to **resolve the problem**.

Anyway, like I said, this video had **the solution** to the problem and **I followed it step by step**, pausing it between each **stage** and within a couple of minutes **the printer was working**. In the past, **in the dark ages before the Internet was invented**, I don't know what we did to solve problems. I guess you always had to get someone else to do it for you **whereas** now you can fix many things yourself and, **to be honest, this is a godsend**.

PART 3

Do you think many people waste their time online?

Oh absolutely, 100% yes.

People go online to look for one thing and several hours later **they're stuck in an internet wormhole**.

Going down an Internet wormhole is utterly addictive. Many find it impossible to get up and walk away because the internet is **intoxicating**.

Maren Morris Says She's 'Lost in a BTS Wormhole,' Reveals Her Favorite Track Is 'Mic Drop'



Describe a quiz or game show that you like

You should say:

- What it is
- How you know about it
- What is it like
- And explain why you like it

Well, I'll start with a confession, I can't stand quiz or game shows. I know they are incredibly popular and I am probably weird for not liking them, but I don't understand the appeal. Anyway, there is one I am aware of and can talk about and it is called 'Who wants to be a millionaire?'

I'm guessing that you have probably heard of it because, as far as I am aware, it is shown in many countries around the world. It is not a team game, it is played solo and there are 15 questions to answer and if the person can answer them all, then they become a millionaire. That sounds easy, but the questions get increasingly more difficult so the first one is relatively easy and the last one is incredibly tricky. If there is a question that the contestant cannot answer then they have a number of options. Each contestant has three lifelines.

Cue Card - Activity

What this means is they have three chances to get help. One of the lifelines is a 50:50 option so two wrong answers are removed.

Another one is to ask the audience and they vote on what they think is the correct answer and the other one is phone a friend so you can nominate a friend to call during the show and they have 30 seconds to help you.

The reason I heard about it was that when it first started there was a famous episode when the contestant won the million pounds.

However, a few months later, he was accused of cheating his way to the jackpot because his wife, Diana, and another contestant, had apparently coughed when the correct answer was mentioned. There was a court case and he was found guilty. So, I am sorry I am unable to comment on why I like these kinds of shows because they're just not my thing, I'm afraid.

PART 3

Why do some people like to watch TV on their computers?

There are a number of reasons for this. Firstly, it is more **convenient** because if it is a laptop you can watch it anytime, anywhere...

Secondly, nowadays, most people don't watch **terrestrial TV**, they watch TV **on catch up**.

Although many modern TVs **are capable of accessing platforms like Netflix**, some older TVs aren't so you need to use a PC to watch programmes on **streaming services** such as this.

